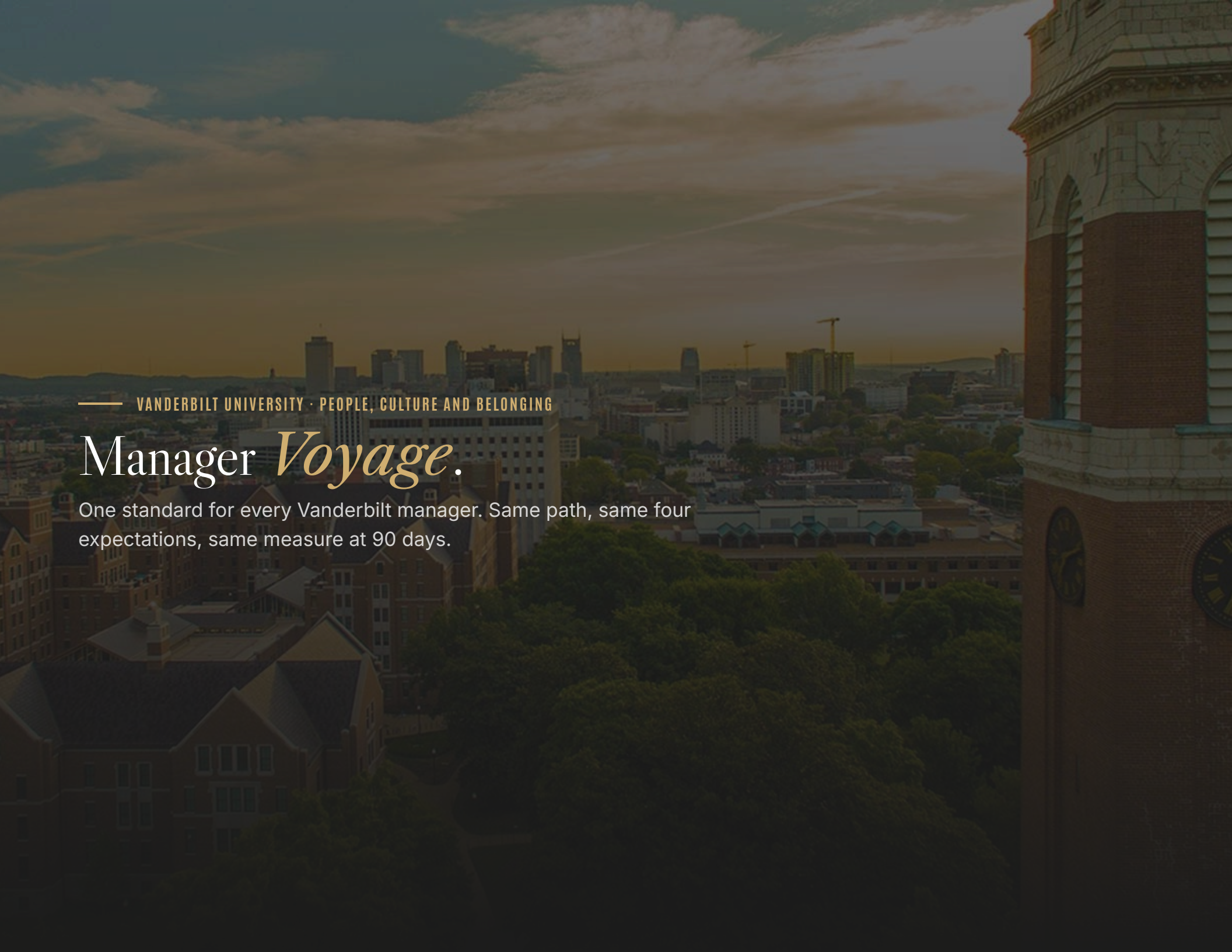


VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY · PEOPLE, CULTURE AND BELONGING

Manager *Voyage*.

One standard for every Vanderbilt manager. Same path, same four expectations, same measure at 90 days.

01 THE VANDERBILT MANAGER STANDARD

Every manager is held to the same four *expectations*.

One standard, every business unit. Taught, measured, practiced.

01

Get the work done

through the team, not around it

02

Take care of your people

listen, grow, thank, trust

03

Make things better

explain the why, let people try, look back

04

Connect your team

to the rest of Vanderbilt

Adapted from Gary Yukl's four categories of leadership behavior. Ten assessment statements, before the program and at 90 days.

YUKL, 2012, THE SOURCE ↗ | THE STANDARD IN THE FOUNDATION COURSE ↗ | THE TEN-STATEMENT ASSESSMENT ↗ | THE THREAD THROUGH THE COHORT ↗ | ASSESSMENT DESIGN NOTE ↗

The standard, *continued*.

WHERE THE STANDARD COMES FROM, AND HOW THE ASSESSMENT MEASURES IT

The standard is adapted from Gary Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (*Academy of Management Perspectives*, 2012). The four expectations are his four categories, the fifteen behaviors are his fifteen, and each of the ten assessment statements is one behavior written as something a manager does in a normal week. Five behaviors have no statement of their own (problem solving, developing, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, networking), so the ten statements sample the standard and the course teaches all fifteen. A self-reflection tool adapted for Vanderbilt, not a validated Yukl instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

EXPECTATION	YUKL'S CATEGORY	THE FIFTEEN BEHAVIORS	ASSESSMENT STATEMENTS
01 Get the work done	Task-oriented	Planning, clarifying, monitoring, problem solving	1 Priorities, 2 Expectations, 3 Checking work
02 Take care of your people	Relations-oriented	Supporting, developing, recognizing, empowering	4 Supporting, 5 Recognizing, 6 Empowering
03 Make things better	Change-oriented	Advocating change, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, facilitating collective learning	7 Leading change, 8 Looking back
04 Connect your team	External	Networking, external monitoring, representing	9 Watching ahead, 10 Representing

02 PROGRAM OVERVIEW

One standard for the first 60 days, and *beyond*.

Assigned automatically from the HR record. Four parts.

4,600+
Staff led by Vanderbilt managers

500+
Vanderbilt managers

39
Business units using the same standard

60
Days covered by the initial path

01 · REQUIRED

Compliance

DAYS 1 TO 60

Legal and policy, by state.

02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

Foundations

COURSE BY DAY 7

Assessment, 35-minute course, micro modules.

03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED

Four-week cohort

QUARTERLY

Practice with your own team.

04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

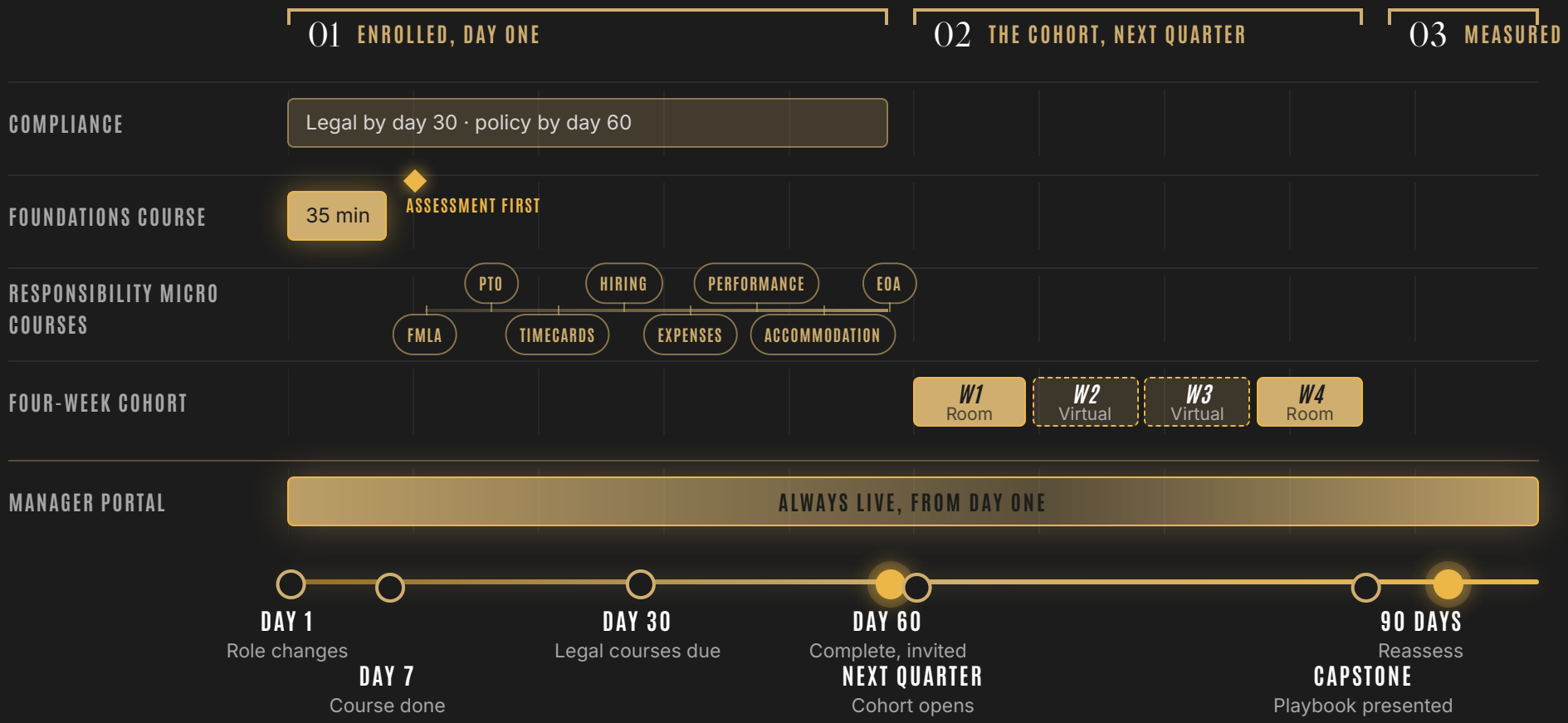
Manager Portal

ALWAYS LIVE

Templates, policy, who to call.

THE JOURNEY

Day one to *ninety*, on one line.



THE JOURNEY

The manager's journey, *continued*.

EACH STAGE, IN A SENTENCE

Day 1, enrolled

- **Enrolled on the first day.** Oracle Learning assigns compliance and Manager Foundations from the HR record. Nothing to request.
- **Compliance.** The legal and policy courses for the state the team works in, supervisor versions included. Legal by day 30, policy by day 60.
- **The Foundations course.** *You Are a Manager Now*, thirty-five minutes online by day seven: the assessment first, then six topics with live conversations, scored.

Days 7 to 60, responsibilities

- **Micro courses, one task each.** FMLA and leave, PTO and timecards, hiring, expenses, the performance cycle, accommodations, reporting to EOA. Short, in Oracle Learning, taken as the responsibility arrives.
- **Day 60.** Recorded against the job profile. The cohort invitation goes out.

Next quarter, the cohort

- **Enroll.** The enrollment survey: a seat request and the team profile, four taps that tailor every scenario.
- **Four weeks.** Week 1 in the classroom, three hours. Weeks 2 and 3 virtual, under ninety minutes. Week 4 the capstone, two hours, the Playbook presented.
- **A survey after every session, then completion.**

Measured, and always live

- **Reassess.** The same ten statements at 90 days, and the team's view from three or more direct reports.
- **The Manager Portal.** Every template, policy link and contact, open from the first day and never taken away.

COMPONENT 01 · REQUIRED · DAYS 1 TO 60

Assigned on day one, matched to the *state*.

No enrollment step. Oracle Learning holds the record.

30
days for courses required by law

60
days for policy courses

1 yr
then most renew

Every location

Cybersecurity · HIPAA · Harassment · Clery · Accommodations

Tennessee

New York

California

Florida

Component 01 · Compliance, *continued*.

EVERY COURSE, BY LOCATION

Every location

- Foundational Cybersecurity Training 30 MIN
- VU HIPAA Privacy and Security Training 60 MIN · LEGAL
- Addressing Harassment and Discrimination at Vanderbilt 35 MIN · LEGAL
- Clery Act 20 MIN · LEGAL
- Guidelines for Reasonable Accommodations in the Workplace 45 MIN · MANAGERS

Tennessee

- Eliminating Discrimination and Harassment in the Workplace 45 MIN
- Harassment Prevention: Manager Essentials 45 MIN · MANAGERS

New York

- Harassment Prevention for Employees, New York City and State 45 MIN · LEGAL
- Harassment Prevention for Supervisors 60 MIN · LEGAL
- New York Retail Worker Safety Act, staff and supervisors 30 MIN · RETAIL ONLY

California

- Sexual Harassment Prevention, employees (SB 1343) 60 MIN · LEGAL
- Sexual Harassment Prevention, supervisors 120 MIN · LEGAL
- Workplace Violence Prevention, employees and supervisors (SB 553) 30 TO 45 MIN · LEGAL

Florida

- Human Trafficking Awareness, lodging staff and supervisors 30 MIN · LEGAL
- Harassment Prevention, employees and supervisors 45 MIN

Delivered through OpenSesame inside Oracle Learning. Each course ends with a knowledge check.

COMPONENT 02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED · DAYS 1 TO 60

What Vanderbilt expects, in *three parts*.

In order. Assigned to every current manager too.

01

The assessment

BEFORE THE COURSE · AGAIN AT 90 DAYS

Ten statements, scored by expectation.

02

The Foundation course

35 MINUTES · COMPLETE BY DAY 7

You Are a Manager Now. Six topics, live conversations.

03

The micro modules

DAYS 1 TO 60 · ORACLE LEARNING

One task each, four tracks.

Done by Day 60: recorded against the job profile, cohort invitation sent.

THE SIX TOPICS AND THE FOUR TRACKS

The Foundation course, six topics

- **What a manager is.** The one change, three things that are new, who helps you.
- **Five ideas.** Priorities, clear expectations, psychological safety, purpose, the people work. A live conversation for each.
- **Your first year.** What Vanderbilt asks for and when, and a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar.
- **The Vanderbilt Manager Standard.** The four expectations, Yukl's category for each, the fifteen behaviors on flip cards, a story per expectation, and the map from expectation to assessment statement, then four live conversations.
- **Your assessment.** The result by expectation, which statements sit under each, and the first move.
- **Next steps.** One action this week, a note to their manager, course complete.

The micro modules, four tracks

- **Systems, by Day 30.** UKG for managers; Oracle time off; Oracle HCM team view and approvals; Oracle Recruiting and Onboarding; expense and procurement approvals.
- **Vanderbilt & Nashville, by Day 30.** The mission and vision; areas of focus; our campuses; Nashville; how we work together.
- **People, by Day 60.** Employee Relations grounding; EOA reporting duty; FMLA; reasonable accommodations; performance concerns simulator; onboarding a new hire.
- **Processes, by Day 60.** Performance Management Foundations; giving feedback; compensation and merit basics; flexible work; offboarding and transitions.

COMPONENT 03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED · QUARTERLY

Where the standard becomes *practice*.

One hundred managers a quarter, with their own teams, in their own words.

WEEK 1 · IN THE CLASSROOM · 3 HOURS

What it means to manage

The mission, your line, the hard conversation out loud.

WEEK 2 · VIRTUAL · UNDER 90 MIN

Goals, 1:1s, difficult conversations

The 1:1 that turns difficult.

WEEK 3 · VIRTUAL · UNDER 90 MIN

Coaching and mentoring

Coach, then hand it over.

WEEK 4 · IN THE CLASSROOM · 2 HOURS

The capstone

The performance conversation, the Playbook presented.

One Playbook, started in the room, one section a week, presented whole in week four.

LOGISTICS AND WHAT EVERY PARTICIPANT PRODUCES

Logistics

- **Week one.** A half day in the classroom, facilitated by the Futures Learning Hub from the cohort site, with timers, talk notes, and a QR code on every page.
- **Weeks two and three.** Virtual, on the manager's own time, capped at ninety minutes.
- **Week four.** Two hours in the classroom. Managers present to peers and their business unit leader.
- **Seats.** One hundred a quarter. Units outside the central budget are billed per seat.

Deliverables

- **Manager Playbook.** The written personal operating system: philosophy, 1:1 framework, delegation and growth plan, performance practice.
- **Integrated Management Model.** A one-page model of how the four expectations connect for this manager. Synthesis, not attendance.
- **Team Development Plan.** A 90-day plan for the actual team: names, goals, growth moves. Challenged by peers and presented in week four.

COMPONENT 03 · WEEK BY WEEK

One expectation a week, one habit *kept*.

BEFORE

Set your team

Four taps. Every scenario rewrites itself.

WEEK 1 · 03 MAKE THINGS BETTER

What it means to manage

Classroom · 3 hours

WEEK 2 · 01 GET THE WORK DONE

Goals, 1:1s, and difficult conversations

Virtual · under 90 minutes

WEEK 3 · 02 TAKE CARE OF YOUR PEOPLE

Coaching and mentoring

Virtual · under 90 minutes

WEEK 4 · 04 CONNECT YOUR TEAM

Performance, talent, and your Playbook

Classroom · 2 hours · the capstone

EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

Week 1 · In the classroom · 3 hours

ROOM	The mission, fifteen minutes: what your team makes possible, in one sentence. The pulse, first reading.
ACTIVITIES	Your voyage on a timeline, from the work you were hired for to year one. A week of your own work sorted into the four expectations. Which expectation your team needs most, and the habit that serves it.
LAB	The hard conversation, fifty minutes: the three-line frame, a demonstration, pairs, then live with Sam on your phone.
PLAYBOOK	Section 1: Manager Philosophy, written and read aloud to your four.

Week 2 · Virtual · under 90 minutes

CORE	How to Manage Difficult Conversations, in Oracle Learning, 30 minutes.
LAB	SparkWise, 45 minutes: conversation prep with peers. Bring the one you have been putting off; leave with it framed in three lines.
SIMULATION	The 1:1 that turns difficult. Dev has missed two dates and opens as if nothing is wrong. Ten minutes, tailored to your team.
PLAYBOOK	Section 2: cadence, agenda, three goals per person, your opening sentence.

COMPONENT 03 · WEEK BY WEEK

The cohort · Week by week, *continued*.

EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

Week 3 · Virtual · under 90 minutes

CORE	Coaching Skills for Leaders and Managers, in Oracle Learning, 35 minutes.
LAB	SparkWise, 40 minutes: the delegation lab and coach or correct. What you will hand off this month, to whom, with what boundary.
SIMULATION	Coach, then hand it over. Priya wants to grow and expects you to tell her how. Ask first; then a real decision with one boundary and a date.
PLAYBOOK	Section 3: one line per person, where they want to be, the stretch assignment, the rung.

Week 4 · In the classroom · 2 hours

RECAP	The four expectations read back against three weeks: what you tried, what held, what did not.
PRACTICE	The performance conversation with Marcus, who expects a promotion you cannot give this cycle. Pairs, then live.
PRESENT	Five minutes each in fours, business unit leaders in the room: the sentence at the center, the team goal, one person's plan by name, the habit you kept. Peers challenge one goal, one move, one date.
CLOSE	The pulse, second reading, beside the week-one answers. The 90-day reassessment date.

COMPONENT 04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

The Manager *Portal*.

Every template, policy link and contact. Open from day one, never taken away.

TEMPLATES	1:1 agenda, conversation frame, delegation ladder, Playbook.
POLICY	Leave, flexible work, accommodations, performance.
BEYOND	Vetted podcasts, videos, guides.

WHO TO CALL

Same-day routes and everyday *help*.

YOUR HCM	The first call, the same day.
ENGAGEMENT CONSULTANT	The bigger people questions.
LEAVE OFFICE	FMLA, time off, injuries. Never ask for a diagnosis.
EOA	Report the same day. You do not investigate.

HOW IT WAS BUILT, AND HOW IMPACT IS MEASURED

Built with managers, measured at *90 days*.

THE EXPERT GROUP

Seven divisions

Set the rules and the Day 30 and 60 bar.

THE PILOT · MARCH 26, 2026

Fifteen managers, eight units

Completed it all. Shaped the design.

NOW LIVE

Automatic assignment

Assigned from the HR record.

NOVEMBER 1, 2026

Wide launch

All managers. First cohort of one hundred.

80%

of M1 to M5 managers enrolled

3 of 4

expectations improved per manager, at 90 days

10

statements, before and after, by expectation

THE OUTCOMES WE EXPECT, AND HOW WE WILL SEE THEM

Engaged

- Managers who understand the role, take ownership of it, and stay at Vanderbilt.
- **How we will see it:** enrollment and Day 60 completion in Oracle Learning against the 80 percent target; cohort seats filled each quarter.

Supporting

- Teams with clear expectations, timely feedback, and the confidence to raise concerns.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in getting the work done and taking care of people.

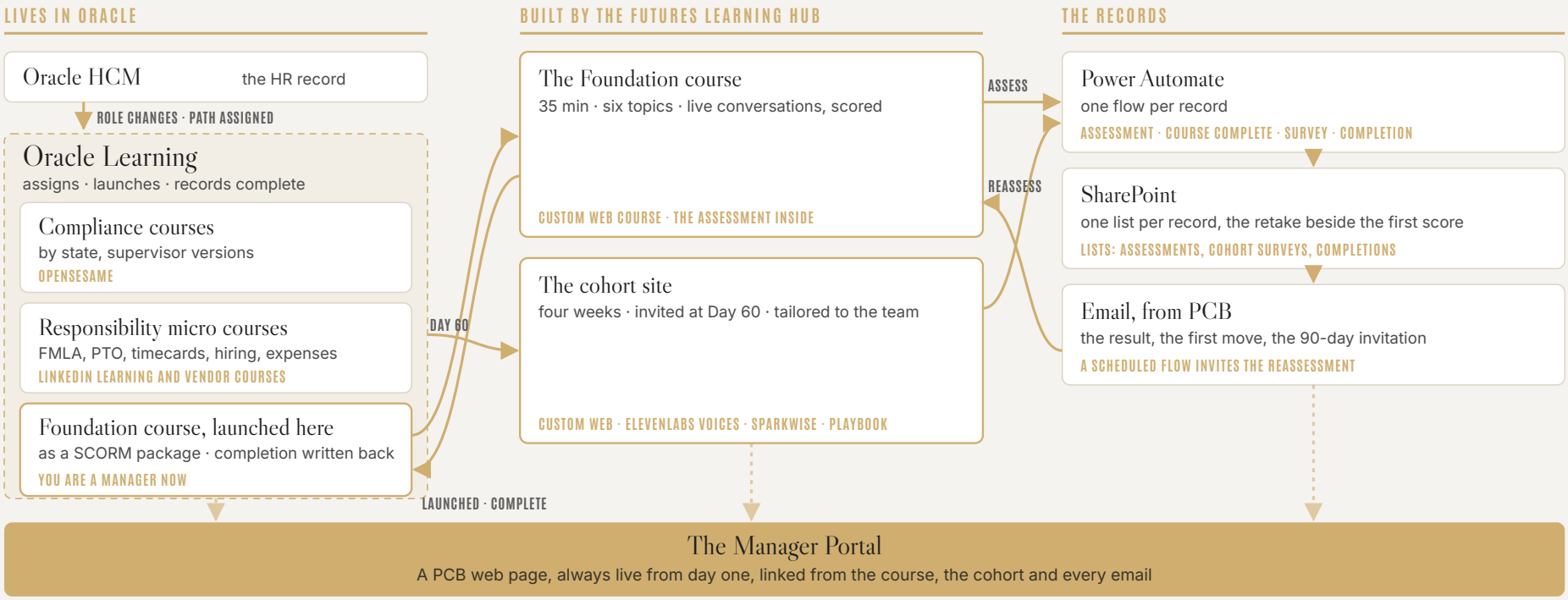
Championing

- Managers who can explain Vanderbilt's purpose in their own words and connect the team's work to it.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in making things better and connecting the team; completion of the Vanderbilt & Nashville track.

The standard and the assessment are adapted from Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (2012): the four expectations are his four categories and the ten statements are ten of his fifteen behaviors. An adaptation for Vanderbilt, not a validated instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

BEHIND THE SCENES

Three places, one *program*.



Behind the scenes · How it was built and how it connects, *continued*.

HOW EACH RECORD MOVES, AND WHAT IS IN IT

In Oracle

- **Oracle HCM to Oracle Learning.** A role change on the HR record assigns compliance, the Foundation course and the micro courses, with due dates. Nothing to request.
- **Compliance and micro courses.** Vendor courses (OpenSesame, LinkedIn Learning) inside Oracle Learning, assigned by state and by duty.
- **The Foundation course launches from Oracle Learning** as a SCORM package, and SCORM writes completion back against the job profile.

Built by the Futures Learning Hub

- **The Foundation course** is a custom web course: six topics, live conversations that answer back and are scored, the ten-statement assessment inside it.
- **The cohort site** is a custom web site: scenarios tailored to the team, five ElevenLabs voice characters scored on the phone, SparkWise learning labs, and the Playbook PDF. Both are one static site on GitHub, served by Vercel.

The records

- **One flow per record.** The assessment, course completion, each cohort survey and the cohort completion post to a Power Automate flow, which writes a SharePoint list row and sends the branded email from the PCB mailbox. A second, scheduled flow invites the reassessment at 90 days and stores the retake beside the first score.
- **Stays on the phone.** Team profiles, Playbook drafts, timeline moments and lab outcomes, unless the manager presses send.

MANAGER DEVELOPMENT JAM SESSION · WHAT WE HEARD

You stated. We *listened*.

Five themes from the Manager Development Jam Session. Each one shaped the program.

YOU STATED

Make it practical.

WE LISTENED

Real conversations, a three-tap week, the templates.

YOU STATED

Learn across Vanderbilt.

WE LISTENED

Cross-unit cohorts, labs on someone else's case.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

YOU STATED

Learn by doing.

WE LISTENED

Rehearse in a lab, then do it for real.

YOU STATED

Build the talent bench.

WE LISTENED

Coaching, delegation, a 90-day plan by name.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

YOU STATED

Reinforce how we lead.

WE LISTENED

One standard, taught, practiced, measured.

WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

Make it practical.

"Give managers simple tools for 1:1s, people decisions, difficult situations, and the everyday work of managing."

Every activity in the Foundation course is a conversation a manager will actually have, and the course ends with a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar: 1:1s, the team meeting, the monthly and quarterly work, and what to do as needed.

The Manager Portal holds the 1:1 agenda, the three-line conversation frame, the delegation ladder, and every policy route with the office it goes to, from Day 1 onward.

Learn across Vanderbilt.

"Use cross-functional cohorts to build relationships, empathy, and a better understanding of how the university works."

The four-week cohort seats one hundred managers a quarter from across the 39 business units, in small SparkWise Learning Labs that work a live case from someone else's team, with a classroom week one and a capstone where managers present to peers from other units.

The Vanderbilt & Nashville track covers the mission, the areas of focus, our campuses, and how we work together, and Who to call names the people a manager's team depends on.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

Learn by doing.

"Blend in-person experiences, real scenarios, SMEs, and practice in the flow of work."

The course teaches through live conversations with a team member who answers back, scored on what the manager says. The cohort rehearses each week's conversation in a simulation lab tailored to the manager's own team, then has it for real: one 1:1 cadence set, one hard conversation held, one decision handed over, with the manager's own team.

Subject-matter experts from seven divisions wrote the routing rules and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations, and fifteen managers from eight units tested the whole program first.

Build the talent bench.

"Help managers spot potential, create enrichment opportunities, enable lateral and diagonal mobility, and develop their successors."

Growing people and handing over decisions, not just tasks, are written into the standard itself. Week 3 of the cohort is coaching and mentoring: for each person on the team, where they want to be, one stretch assignment, and their rung on the delegation ladder.

The Team Development Plan sets 90-day growth moves by name, is challenged by peers in week 4, and is presented to the business unit leader at the capstone.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

Reinforce how we lead.

"Build shared expectations around collaboration, accountability, sound people practices, and care for frontline staff."

The Vanderbilt Manager Standard: four expectations of every manager, adapted from Yukl's research, the same in every business unit, taught in the course, measured by the ten-statement assessment before the program and again at 90 days, and practiced in the cohort.

Compliance and the People track put sound people practice on every manager's path, and taking care of the people on the team is one of the four categories, not an elective.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

THE COMMITMENTS WE MADE IN THE ROOM, AND WHERE THEY LED

Next steps named at the jam session

- Validate internal versus external hiring manager data.
- Invite DAR and Facilities as volunteer pilot partners.
- Present the manager development prototype to VBOM for feedback and further refinement.
- Schedule the next session to review and refine the prototype.

How the program keeps listening

- The pulse survey before week one and again at the capstone, and the week-four recap, where managers say what happened when they tried it.
- The ten-statement assessment before the program and at 90 days, which shows where the program is working and where it is not.
- Feedback from each cohort shapes the next quarter's design, the same way the pilot shaped this one.

From the jam session to launch

STEP 1

Jam session

Managers and leaders set the five themes and the next steps.

STEP 2

Expert group

Seven divisions defined the routing rules, Who to call, and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations.

STEP 3 · MARCH 26, 2026

Pilot

Fifteen managers from eight units completed the full program. Their feedback shaped the current design.

STEP 4 · NOVEMBER 1, 2026

Wide launch

Open to all managers, with the first full cohort of one hundred.

NEXT STEPS

Live now. Measured by *spring*.

01

NOW

Open to every manager

Compliance and the Foundation course assigned from the HR record. The Portal live.

02

THIS QUARTER

First cohort of one hundred

Seats by invitation at Day 60. Surveys to SharePoint after every session.

03

AT 90 DAYS

The first reassessment

The same ten statements, by expectation. The team's view from three or more reports.

04

EACH QUARTER AFTER

The next cohort, shaped by the last

Survey and reassessment results change the design, the same way the pilot did.

Manager Voyage · Futures Learning Hub · People, Culture and Belonging · Vanderbilt University